

Workspace 'Running notes' in 'Politics after Indian Independence'

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1. POLITICS AFTER INDIA'S INDEPENDENCE

Faculty Profile

6/8/26

- i) Began with "Why do we need to study this subject?"
- ii) Likes quantitative analysis.
- iii) Likes neatness & symmetry.
- iv) Appreciates lucidity & simplicity in the answers.
- v) Questions → a) According to you, what is this course investigating?
 - b) Can we rephrase the title of this course?
 - c) How did you picture the transition phase?
 - d) What triggered the Britishers to leave the country?
- vi) Insisting on the transition phase & whether it was gradual or hasty?
- vii) More Questions → e) Do you agree with the manner in which India achieved its freedom?
 - f) Why did India's Independence become a remarkable event not just for India but also for the rest of the world?
- viii) Stated that "Migration affected part of the country but communal violence affected the whole."

7/8/26

- i) Appreciates reading material being covered fully.
- ii) Focused on the title of the book & its difference from the NCERT Book.
- iii) History of Modern India by Bipin Chandra — Stated that this book is also a must read alongside Bidyut's book.
- iv) India after Gandhi by Ramachandra Guha — Stated that this book is a must read as well, alongside the other two.
- v) The Idea of India by Sunil Khilwani — Stated that this book is a must read as well alongside the other three.
- vi) Revision of the questions put forth on 6/8/26 → the answers of which → a) Nation building. Why? Because it is an ongoing process.
- vii) Does not necessarily prefer brevity.

13/8/26

- i) Began with the nature of the transitional stage.
- ii) What were the legacies which we continued? — Stated that this is a very important question.
 - a) The colonial legacies
 - b) National movement legacy
- iii) Stated that since legacies could not be eliminated, that is why we could not completely break off with the past.

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iv) Talked about the order of the Constituent Assembly & legitimacy of the Constituent Assembly.

ix) Put forth the question → How can the Constituent Assembly if it is a branch of the politicians?

vi) What was the legitimacy of the Indian govt. as established by Nehru? — Put forth this question as well.

vii) What were the major ideological influences which seem to have been critical in Indian Politics?

viii) Talked about the introductions of the different reading materials provided.

ix) Showed video — Talk on "History beyond Chauvinism" by Dr. Ramachandra Guha.

14/8/26

i) Began with the assignment of the topics for the Article Review.

ii) The above i) must be submitted on 17th August 2026 (Monday).

iii) Began with the class's discussion on the "Story of Partition".

iv) Put forth the question — "Whether the Partition was inevitable or not?"

v) Continued putting forth the questions — a) When did the Partition begin & progressed?

b) Whom do we blame?

c) Suddenly asked about the legitimacy of the 1947 National government.

d) Why was the partition a complex process?

e) What were the facts, including the figures/numerical data?

f) Which legal enactment formalized it? Did it receive Royal Assent?

g) Which of the 2 provinces went through the deepest trauma?

h) Why did a large no. of people not know on the day of Independence, if they were in India or in Pakistan?

i) What was the most uncontrolled problem that occurred on the eve of partition or on Independence?

j) Consequences of partition.

17/8/26

i) Began with stating that topic has been allotted, have to study that from the best reading material possible.

ii) Likes the question that has been put forth to be reframed in such a way that makes answering it easier & more holistically.

iii) Still emphasising upon Partition & using such topics to emphasise his method of answering & researching.

iv) Started focusing upon "Integration" of the States.

v) Stated that there is a difference between "Integration" & "reorganisation".

vi) Stated that a byword of reorganisation is "redrawing" the boundaries.

vii) Focuses on legends for correct answers.

20/8/26

i) Began with "Consequences of Partition" — 2 parts → a) Immediate/Short term.

b) Long term. Eg → Race, caste, class, terrorism.

ii) Starting the above i) in relation to the sub-continent — South Asia.

iii) Stated about SAARC in relation to above ii).

iv) Put forth the question — "How did the Indian govt. respond to the migration?"

v) Stated that Professor likes answers in a very concrete manner — based on the realities & actual data.

vi) Started discussing about the "Nagans" (for eg → Matiyang Nagan) & its connection with Refugee population.

The Nagan Story Prof. treats it as — I suspect this is important.

vii) Suddenly stated about emphasizing the distinction between the provincial government of princely States — the Dham of the Prince/Princess.

viii) Stated about the legal status of the princely States.

ix) Stated that integration happened in 2 parts → a) Pre-Independence b) Post-Independence.

x) Stated that Case studies have to be read for the integration story.

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- xi) Put forth the question → "State 2 case law which is connected to the Integration of princely States."
- xii) Stated about the 3 types of agreements that happened between the Union & the princely States, & the allowances given to the Princes.
- xiii) Madhusudan v Union of India.

21/8/26

- i) Began by asking whether students have read the readings given or not.
- ii) Stated that the topics Partition & State Reorganisation are part of the Ramachandra Guha's book.
- iii) Regarded Ramachandra Guha's book to be of importance, & Prof. personally likes it.
- iv) Began with the topic of State Reorganisation.
- v) Considered the concepts of Division of States on the basis of language to be relevant to the topic.
the linguistic question
- vi) Stated that Congress was not against the linguistic segregation.
- vii) Stated that Nehru, Patel & Rajagopalachari were against the linguistic reorganisation.
- viii) Focused on the reading material / the author, the case studies — Pongal case study, Gadchali case study.
- ix) Stated Not to confuse the linguistic with the religious identity.
- x) T. Pratyush Kumar — resigned Congress & supported the movement.
- xi) Began with how Patil Shrinivasa (follower of Gandhi) came into the picture of this movement.
- xii) Talked about his past hunger strikes & those for the movement.
- xiii) Gandhi wrote a Long Note on the character of this person (above named).
- xiv) Talked about how the Black Flag was raised in Gadchali, whenever Nehru came.
- xv) Stated about the Commission the author talked about.
- xvi) Began with the story of Maharashtra movement.
- xvii) Stated that the Chief Minister of Bihar & WB issued a joint statement proposing that their two States be merged into one State.
- xviii) Stated talking about the Dhar Commission, JVP Commission, Fazl Ali Commission.
- xix) Stated that the Fazl Ali Commission's Report led to the 1956 Act.
3 members — none were associated with the Congress party.
- xx) Stated that for the exam — the Commission's Report is important.
- xxi) Constantly emphasising that the reading materials provided, & asked to be read, are very important for the exam.

27/8/26

- i) Began by stating that the "Legitimacy of the 1947 Government" was unanswered by the class — repeated this topic again in this class.
- ii) Put forth the question to the class — "what was the legitimacy of the legislations made during the period of 1947 to 1952, especially during the absence of the legislature, and the absence of the Constitution?"
- iii) Stated that we have to look at what actually happened, in order to get clarity on the processes used.
- iv) Showed slide with questions — in reference to above enumerations, "how was it both political and legal process?" and "How did the Constitution become the stabilising framework?" and "How the interrelation could be labelled as "Coerced", Conciliated and Coalesced?" and "What is the difference between Accession agreement and Merger agreement?"
- v) Stated that above iv) can be answered from the readings provided, only if read properly.
- vi) Stated about the 26th Amendment.
- vii) Showed the total number of legislations that were "passed" in each year of 1947, 1949, 1950, 1951, 1952.
- viii) Stated 4 Articles of the Constitution that acted as the stabilising framework — in order to accommodate the princely states — Art. 291, 362, 363, 366(22).
- ix) Showed slide on questions for State Reorganisation — Professor is contrary to Guha — it was not the end of the State Reorganisation but rather the beginning of the State Reorganisation. Stated that Guha's conclusion on this topic is beautiful, however, his views are as mentioned above — Put forth the question — "Why the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 was a foundational reorganisation statute, not the continuing legal source of subsequent State reorganisations?"
- x) Put forth another question with respect to the above ix) — "How were the Sikkim and Goa cases different?"
- xi) Put forth the question — "what was the Seventh amendment of the Constitution?" — showed slide on what the Seventh amendment did — a) abolished Part A, B, C, D distinction.
- xii) Stated the relation between State Reorganisation and Article 371 — stated this this needs to be discussed — stated that Article 371 is a supplementary provision for State Reorganisation, but it is not an conclusive provision, according to Professor — stated that it's not just a single article, but divided into multiple sub articles, because it is adapted to the States and their requirements. Stated the Reorganisation related case laws — 1960, 1960, 1961, 1966, 1966, 1970, 2001, 2023.
- xiii) Stated that he's going to be beginning with the Unit II with this topic — Transitioning from a reactive anti-colonial nationalism to a proactive civic nation-building project.
- xiv) Stated that repetition must not be done of the topics, but more investigation needs to be done.
- xv) With the way Professor is emphasising on the readings and his interest on the readings, I am strongly influenced on the readings being the primary source.
- xvi) Also introduced the topic of Post Independence Identity Trajectory — Core focus of identity and Major Drivers.
- xvii) For above xvi) — I have taken Picture of the slide he showed. Will upload when you say — additionally, it will serve as a small data source of his personality, on the basis of his framing of the slides.

31/8/26

- i) Began with posing a question on the topic — "What do you understand about the Civic Nation Building Project?"
- ii) Posed another question with regard to above i) — "Define the interpretation and meaning of the Civic Nation Building Project?"
- iii) Stated that the above i) and ii) are with respect to "immediately after the Independence".
- iv) Put the question — "India's political journey, India's constitutional journey, India's democratic journey after the Independence — what is the distinction between the 3, and all 3 fall in a different timeline, why? and How do you explain all 3 falling in different timelines?"
- v) Stated for above iv) — the political journey started with the independence, constitutional journey started in 31st January (did not hear the date), democratic journey from 1952 — first general elections. Stated that the clarity needs to be there for when the journeys actually begin, with regard to "after the Independence".
- vi) Stated again — "What is the legitimacy of the National Government?" — stated that he has been asking this question for quite a long time — I am taking this frustration as a hint that it might appear in the Exam either conceptually or in an analytical question format.

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a hint that it might appear in the exam, either separately, or in an analytical question format.

vii) Clarified that the "Executive" is what he means with "National Government".

viii) "What 1947 Indian Independence Act proposed? This is the legal argument." — Stated that this is the key to the legitimacy of the National government question.

ix) Emphasises upon giving legal arguments since we are law students.

x) For above viii) Also stated that discussion on the Constituent Assembly needs to be done for the legitimacy question.

xi) Put another question — "What is the nature, composition and performance of the First government of India, which was formed in 1947?"

xii) I am consistently observing that Professor's classes are simply questions put to the class, with the expectation that we would be able to "argue" them, on the basis of the reading material provided and other knowledge that we possess. This is also pointing to the analytical logic format that you created.

xiii) Stated that "composition not only includes the names of the members, but also where they came from, their relevant journey."

xiv) Put question — "Whether all the members who formed, were from the Constituent Assembly? If not, where from, and how many of them?"

xv) Put another question — "Whether the first national government was a Parliamentary form of government or not?"

xvi) Stated that the "last part of the question — the "performance" part, is an evaluative form of question".

xvii) Stated that he need not expect "his" form of correct answer, he wants the argument given in the answer, to be legal and based in the readings done (essentially, they should be not factually or analytically incorrect) — of course this is not to mean that his framing should be ignored, as this statement is a pretty way to make sure that less marks are obtained, since it is always better to attune to the person "giving" the marks, therefore this statement can be ignored, or used to modify the strategy to attain to the object even more.

xviii) Stated that during the time from 1947 to 1952, the Constituent Assembly made the laws, therefore they were playing a dual role — Constitution making power and the Legislative power assigned by the section 8 (1) of 1947 Act. Connecting a part of this question to how many members there were, how was this double role being done? — what he means by "how" — How did the members differentiate between their roles as Constituent Assembly member and Legislature making member?

xix) Put forth the question — "Whether there is a difference between the Speaker of the Legislature, and the Chairman of the Constituent Assembly?"

xx) Stated that — "There is a difference between Constituent Assembly Speaker and Constituent Assembly Chairman."

xxi) Again emphasised on Section 8(1) of the 1947 Act, acting as the law making authorisation for the Constituent Assembly.

xxii) Also stated about the Section 8(2) of the 1947 Act — about the Government of India Act — "We thought that the Government of India Act had stopped, but this serves as a transitory permission to still operate."

xxiii) Mentioned about the "Transitional power" given by the Constitution — very important Article.

3/9/26

i) Began with a revision of the 31/8/26 class.

ii) Began with the question — "What happened to the power of the Constituent Assembly after 1950 i.e. after the Constitution came into being?"

iii) Stated that above ii) question — "Why did this question arise? ; What happened after 1950?"

iv) Stated that the Constitution had the Transitional power enumerated in it — Stated about Part XXI and the Transformation Clause (Article 379) — Article 379(1) was explicitly mandated: "Until both Houses of Parliament have been duly constituted and summoned... the body functioning as the Constituent Assembly of the Dominion of India immediately before the commencement of this Constitution shall be the provisional Parliament..." — Next enumeration in PPT Slide — Immediate Activation: While the rest of the Constitution became active on Republic Day, Article 379 was deliberately activated early on November 26, 1949. This ensured that the legal conversion of the body on January 26 was automated and valid. — Next enumeration in PPT Slide — The Executive Bridge (Article 380): To complete the state apparatus, Article 380 dictated that the person elected by the Constituent assembly as president would remain the interim president of India until the proper general elections occurred. Once the first democratically elected Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha were formed in April 1952, these temporary constitutional bridges naturally expired.

v) Put forth the question — "What is your understanding of the Republican Transition? What is your conception of Republicanism or Republic?"

vi) Slowly going into the elements of "being Republic" and distinguishing between its normally known elements, and its absolutely fundamental elements, without which the Class of Republic would not exist.

vii) Going into the irony of nations which have republic in their name, have constitutions, nations like UK which are still not republic yet people choose their own representatives — therefore there must be some other "fundamental" element whose direct consequence is actually being "Republic".

viii) Stated that according to Professor's first element — "Head of the State should be elected — there is no specification whether direct election or indirect election of such Head."

ix) Put forth the question — "What type of arrangement did India have on 1950? — we had PM before the elections" — connected it to legitimacy of the National government.

x) Stated that "The reason we called National Government the "National Government" is because it was not Congress based ministry, but inclusive in nature. The reason is not simply because it was governing the entire nation — because it is not a party based arrangement, but an interim arrangement offered by the Indian Independent Act."

xi) Stated that the question — "If Nehru was an architect or spoiler, the argument for that should be done from the reading of Performance of the National Government".

xii) Showed a statement on PPT Slide — by Patel — Sardar Patel remarked that "even the windows of the Constituent Assembly are closed for Dr. Ambedkar" and that he would "see how he enters". Discussed on the positive or negative interpretation that can be done from this. Then showed another statement — "Dr. Ambedkar's nomination has been sent to PM. I hope there would be no contest and he would be returned unopposed so that he would come here on 14th."

xiii) Unit 1, 2, 3 — Syllabus for Mid Sem exams.